GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Road Transport & Highways

Building the Roads to India's Future

Confidential and Proprietory
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SHRI NARENDRA MODI

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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HONORABLE MINISTER, MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT AND HIGHWAYS



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MESSAGE

A robust road transport and highway network is fundamental to India's economic growth, regional connectivity, trade competitiveness, and social development. The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways has been instrumental in transforming the nation's infrastructure landscape through the development of world-class highways, expressways, logistics corridors, and sustainable mobility solutions that strengthen connectivity across urban and rural India.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) recognizes that modern transportation infrastructure serves as a catalyst for investment, industrial expansion, employment generation, and balanced regional development. Through policy advocacy, infrastructure partnerships, investment facilitation, technology adoption, innovation promotion, startup engagement, and industry collaboration, CCI India remains committed to supporting the Ministry's vision of creating a safe, efficient, and future-ready transportation ecosystem.

This Knowledge Paper provides comprehensive insights into the Ministry's strategic priorities, infrastructure initiatives, policy reforms, investment opportunities, and emerging technologies shaping India's road transport sector. It explores opportunities across intelligent transportation systems, green mobility, highway infrastructure, road safety, logistics optimization, electric vehicle ecosystems, digital infrastructure, and sustainable construction practices.

The publication serves as a valuable reference for policymakers, infrastructure developers, construction companies, investors, technology providers, academic institutions, logistics operators, research organizations, and development agencies seeking to contribute to India's transportation transformation. Through stronger collaboration and knowledge exchange, it aims to accelerate infrastructure development, improve mobility, strengthen logistics efficiency, and promote sustainable economic growth.

As India advances towards becoming one of the world's leading economies, modern transportation infrastructure will remain a key driver of national competitiveness. CCI India remains dedicated to partnering with the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways in building a connected, resilient, and globally competitive transportation network.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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Preface

India stands at an inflection point in its infrastructural evolution. The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) sits at the nerve centre of this transformation, orchestrating the construction, modernisation, and governance of a road network that is the second-largest in the world. Roads are not merely physical infrastructure - they are the arteries through which commerce flows, livelihoods are sustained, and regional aspirations are fulfilled.

This knowledge paper has been prepared by the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI India) as a strategic advisory instrument - not a commentary on ministry performance, but an analytical framework for structured collaboration. Its purpose is to map the ministry's institutional architecture, developmental priorities, execution gaps, and investment landscape with sufficient precision to identify where organised industry participation can materially advance national objectives. CCI India's conviction is that the distance between policy intention and on-ground outcome is most effectively bridged through organised, credible, and technically equipped intermediaries who understand both government systems and market realities.

The paper is organised across twenty-one sections, moving from institutional history and landscape analysis through gap identification, opportunity assessment, and a five-year strategic roadmap. Each section has been designed to deliver a distinct analytical perspective, ensuring that readers - whether they are Union Ministers, senior secretaries, NITI Aayog officials, development finance institutions, or private investors - encounter insights that are specific, actionable, and grounded in evidence.

CCI India's vision for this collaboration is anchored in three convictions. First, that India's road infrastructure ambitions cannot be realised without deep, structured private sector participation across financing, construction, technology, logistics, and governance. Second, that the startup and innovation ecosystem has produced solutions - in AI-based traffic management, vehicle telematics, road condition monitoring, and green construction materials - that remain disconnected from procurement and piloting pathways at the ministry level.

This paper is addressed to Union Ministers and Secretaries to the Government of India, senior officials of NITI Aayog and the Ministry of Finance, industry leaders and investors active in the infrastructure sector, development finance institutions and multilateral agencies engaged in India's infrastructure financing, and international institutions exploring strategic cooperation with India's road sector ecosystem.

It is offered in the spirit of constructive partnership - with the recognition that the government's institutional capacity, when amplified by industry expertise, civil society networks, and innovation ecosystems, can accelerate outcomes that neither can achieve independently.

Chamber of Commerce and Industry (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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Section 1: Introduction to the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) is one of the most consequential infrastructure ministries in the Government of India's institutional architecture. Its mandate encompasses the development, maintenance, and management of national highways; the formulation and implementation of road transport policies; vehicle and driver regulation; road safety governance; and the oversight of the transport research and standards ecosystem. The ministry's work is not confined to laying asphalt - it shapes how goods move, how people commute, and how the logistics economy functions across a geographically diverse and economically complex nation.

Constitutional and Legislative Mandate

Roads and motor vehicles appear on both the Union List (Entry 23 - Highways declared by Parliament to be national highways) and the Concurrent List (Entry 35 - Mechanically propelled vehicles) of the Seventh Schedule to the Constitution of India. This dual jurisdictional character means that while the union government exercises authority over national highways and inter-state transport, state governments retain concurrent legislative and executive responsibility over state highways, district roads, and village roads. The Central Government's leadership is therefore as much about coordination, standard-setting, and fiscal transfer architecture as it is about direct execution.

The primary legislative instruments governing the ministry's work include the National Highways Act, 1956 (as amended); the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988 (comprehensively amended in 2019); the National Highways Authority of India Act, 1988; the Road Transport Corporations Act, 1950; and the Land Acquisition Act as applied to highway projects. The Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Act, 2019 was a landmark legislative reform, introducing significantly enhanced penalties for traffic violations, provisions for facial recognition in licencing, mandatory third-party insurance reform, and a Solatium Fund strengthening for accident victims.

Governance Role and Institutional Mandate

MoRTH functions as the apex policy authority for road transport in India. Its governance role is operationalised through a combination of regulatory standard-setting, investment programming, project oversight, and legislative administration. The ministry works through the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) for highway development and toll management; the National Highways and Infrastructure Development Corporation (NHIDCL) for special category states and border-area connectivity; the Indian Academy of Highway Engineers (IAHE) for capacity building; and the National Road Safety Council for safety governance. The Central Motor Vehicle Rules and the Model Motor Vehicle Rules provide the regulatory substrate that state governments are expected to adopt and administer.

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